

FLOWERING / THE CARBOHYDRATE HANDOVER

The new leaves need sugar too.

At flowering, developing leaves draw on stored carbohydrates alongside flowers and young fruit.

The tree is supporting the crop while building the canopy that will help feed it.

Cherry flowering, northeast Victoria.
Photo: Josh Richardson · September 2026

Reserves support the start.

Carbohydrates stored in roots and wood help supply early growth.

A CLOSER LOOK AT THE HANDOVER →

The canopy takes on more.

As leaves develop, current photosynthesis contributes more sugars.

The leaf changes jobs as it grows.

Stored reserves and current photosynthesis overlap through early development.

A young leaf drawing on reserves and an established leaf supplying sugars can be on the same branch.

STILL DEVELOPING

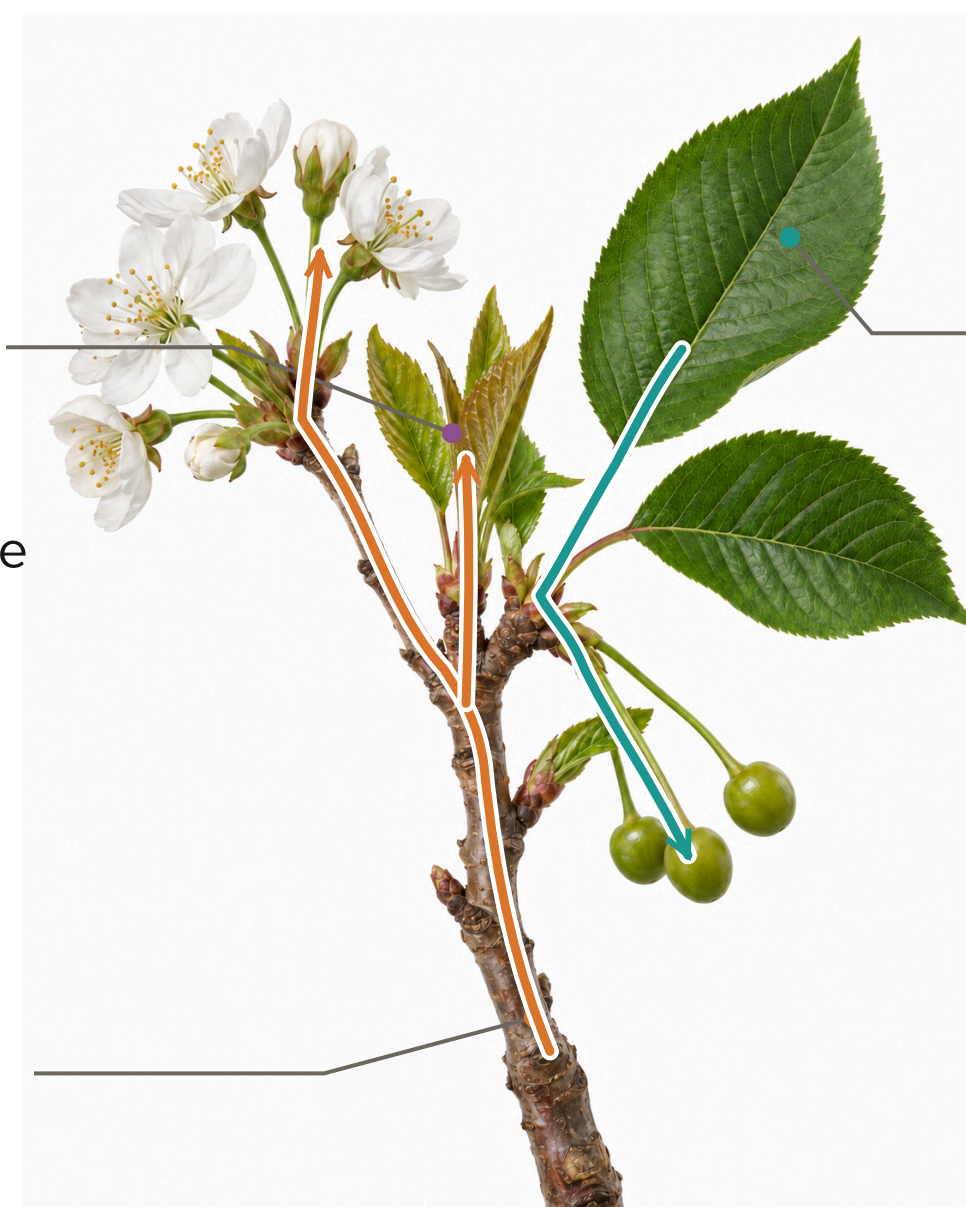
A leaf also has to grow.

It can draw on stored carbohydrates while it develops.

ROOTS AND WOOD

Stored carbohydrates

Support flowers, young fruit and developing leaves.



ESTABLISHED LEAF

Photosynthesis supplies sugars.

It supplies sugars to support growth elsewhere in the tree.

This is a gradual handover. Leaf stages can overlap. The illustration shows the process, not a fixed date or measured flow.

Read the canopy as well as the blossom.

The stage of the leaves adds context to the stage of the flowers.



Field context: northeast Victoria, September 2026. Photo: Josh Richardson.

Carbohydrate supply

Stored reserves and current photosynthesis help meet the demands of the developing crop.

Mineral nutrition

Nutrients support photosynthesis and growth. They do not replace the sugars the tree produces.

If bloom is well advanced but the canopy is lagging, review leaf health, crop demand and root-zone conditions before changing the program.

Cherry tracing research has followed stored carbon into flowers, young fruit and developing leaves.